

Proposed child arrangements plan

Recipient
document

Before you start

Do not use this service if you feel pressured or intimidated into using it. If you or your children are at immediate risk of harm, call 999 and ask for the police.

- **Using this document is voluntary:** You do not have to respond if you do not want to.
- **This is not a legal document or court order:** Any plan you make is not legally binding or enforceable. You or the other parent can suggest changes at any time.
- **This plan will replace older informal agreements:** If you both agree to this plan, it will overwrite any past agreements you made together. It will not overwrite a court order.
- **If there is a court order:** Do not use this document if there is an existing court order about you, the other parent, or the children.

You can also use the service to start your own plan, visit www.propose-child-arrangements-plan.service.gov.uk

Get more information

You can use GOV.UK to find more information, including:

- making child arrangements - <https://www.gov.uk/looking-after-children-divorce>
- find ways to make child arrangements - <https://www.gov.uk/find-ways-to-make-child-arrangements>
- child maintenance service - <https://www.gov.uk/child-maintenance-service>

You can use this document to agree on child arrangements with your child's other parent.

How to respond to this plan

- Read each section of the suggested plan.
- Mark your choice to show if you agree or disagree.
- Add your comments if you want to suggest a change.
- Send the completed document back to Harrison.

For support with technical or user issues, you can email

childarrangements@justice.gov.uk

We are unable to assist with individual court cases or disputes, and we cannot provide procedural or legal advice.

Bob has suggested a child arrangements plan

Bob used the Child Arrangements Plan service (<https://propose-child-arrangements-plan.service.gov.uk/>) on GOV.UK to suggest a plan for how you both might look after James, Rachel and Jack.

How making a child arrangements plan can help

You may find that collaborating with Bob on a child arrangements plan:

- is cheaper and quicker than going to court (it usually takes around 10 months to get a court order, depending on where you live and whether it's urgent)
- leads to a better outcome for your children, of which you and your ex-partner are in control

Your child arrangements plan should:

- put the child's welfare first
- reflect the wishes, feelings and needs of the child

Your safety

You should only respond to the suggested plan if you're confident that you and your ex-partner can make decisions together without putting yourself or the children in danger

If you have any concerns about safety, stop now.

If you have any feedback or safety concerns about this service, you can email childarrangementssafety@justice.gov.uk.

If you decide not to respond to this plan:

- there are no negative consequences
- it will not affect any court cases or your immigration status
- your information will not be shared with anyone

Get help finding a child arrangement option

You can find out about your options for making child arrangements suitable for your circumstances, visit <https://www.gov.uk/find-ways-to-make-child-arrangements>.

You can find an independent family mediator to help you and the other parent understand your options and work out an agreement, visit <https://www.familymediationcouncil.org.uk/find-local-mediator/>

This plan is not suitable for you if there has been:

- any form of domestic abuse or violence, even if the abuse was not directed at the children
- actual or attempted child abduction
- child abuse or neglect
- misuse of drugs, alcohol or other substances
- any other safety or welfare concerns that place anyone at significant risk of harm

Getting help with domestic abuse

Domestic abuse or violence is a crime. You can find out how to recognise domestic abuse, visit <https://www.gov.uk/guidance/domestic-abuse-how-to-get-help#recognise-domestic-abuse>.

If you have experienced any kind of domestic abuse, you can get a court order to protect you or your children, visit <https://www.gov.uk/guidance/domestic-abuse-how-to-get-help#get-a-court-order-to-protectyou-or-your-child>.

Section 1

About this child arrangements proposal

Bob said:

- there is no court order in place at this time
- this is a proposed child arrangements plan for 3 children, James, Rachel and Jack
- this agreement is between Bob and Sam, who are the adults who will care for James, Rachel and Jack

We do not store these names or share any of this information with other government departments.

Do you and Bob agree about the children's names, your names, and whether there is a court order in place?

☐

Yes

☐

No

If you answered 'No', it may be helpful to find a mediator who can help you agree your child arrangements. You can get financial help with this. To find out more, go to <https://www.gov.uk/looking-after-children-divorce>.

Section 2

Living and visiting

Where will the children spend most of their time?

Bob suggested:

"livingAndVisitingArrangement"

Do you agree?

☐

Yes

☐

No

If you do not agree, suggest where the children will spend most of their time

Section 3

Handovers and holidays

How will the children get between households?

Bob suggested that this does not need to be decided.

Do you agree?

☐

Yes

☐

No

If you do not agree, suggest how the children get between households

Where does handover take place?

It may be easier for children if the handover takes place at a neutral location which you're confident you'll both feel safe in.

Bob suggested that this does not need to be decided.

Do you agree?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If you do not agree, suggest where handover takes place

Will these arrangements change during school holidays?

Bob suggested that this does not need to be decided.

Do you agree?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If you do not agree, suggest whether the arrangements should change during the holidays

What items need to go between households?

Bob suggested that this does not need to be decided.

Do you agree?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If you do not agree, suggest which items need to go between households

Special days

What will happen on special days?

Keep your children's feelings at the centre of your plans for holidays and meaningful events. For example, New Year celebrations, Mother's Day and Father's Day, and birthdays.

Bob suggested:

"whatWillHappenAnswer"

Do you agree?

☐

Yes

☐

No

If you do not agree, suggest what will happen on special days

Other things

What other things matter to your children?

You may want to agree things such as:

- religious practices, diet, and standard rules across both households
- extra-curricular activities, such as swimming lessons
- access to other friends and family
- other types of contact, such as video calls

Bob suggested:

"whatOtherThingsMatterAnswer"

Do you agree?

☐

Yes

☐

No

If you do not agree, suggest what other things matter to your children

Decision making

How should last-minute changes be communicated?

There will be times when plans will need to change, such as if one parent is suddenly unwell and cannot collect a child from school.

Bob suggested that this does not need to be decided.

Do you agree?

☐

Yes

☐

No

If you do not agree, suggest how last minute changes should be communicated

How much notice should you give to change long-term arrangements?

Sometimes you may need to plan a long way ahead. For example, if you want to plan a holiday during time you do not usually spend with the children.

Bob suggested that this does not need to be decided.

Do you agree?

☐

Yes

☐

No

If you do not agree, suggest how much notice you should give each other

When would you like to review this plan?

Children's needs change as they grow. When should you review this agreement to check it is still what's best for the children?

Bob suggested that you should review this arrangement in 1 month's time.

Do you agree?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If you do not agree, suggest when you should review this agreement

Section 9

End of form

Is there anything else you would like to suggest for the child arrangements plan?

You can use this space to write any other information you would like included in the plan

Joint agreement

Now that you have recorded your decisions, you should download or print a copy of this plan so you both have one.

You can both sign below to confirm your joint commitment to what you have agreed. As with all parts of this document, you don't have to complete this section if you don't want to.

'As parents of Jason, we jointly accept responsibility for their future welfare, stability, development and happiness. We have discussed and agreed the arrangements laid out in this Plan and commit ourselves to these arrangements. We have also discussed these arrangements with our children. We will jointly re-visit these arrangements in future, as necessary. In this way we will take account of changing circumstances and ensure that our children's best interests come first.'

Legal status of this agreement

This is not a legal contract. By signing above, you are simply confirming that you have jointly agreed to the arrangements. There is no legal commitment in doing so.

If you want to make your agreement legally binding, you can ask a legal adviser to help you apply for a consent order. You can find a legal adviser at: www.gov.uk/find-legal-advice.

What to do next

You can send this proposed child arrangements plan back to Harrison. You should try to create a written record of what you have both agreed.

Any plan you make using this form is not legally binding. The other person does not have to do what it says and either of you can suggest changes to it at any time.

If you cannot reach an agreement

If you do not get a response, or if you cannot agree on a plan together, you can find other ways to make child arrangements on GOV.UK: www.gov.uk/find-ways-to-make-child-arrangements

More information and support is also available at: <https://www.gov.uk/looking-after-children-divorce>.

Get paid to give your feedback

With your help we can improve this service and understand how you use your plan. Sign up and receive an incentive when you take part in further research <https://www.smartsurvey.co.uk/s/EFO5FJ/>